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There were over 8,000 parliamentary questions in the last legislative period. The Chamber has published a document in which they are all collected. An analysis by woxx about the question-and-answer game of the deputies.



At question time in parliament – such as here on 12 March – MEPs can ask the ministers questions as they please. However, most parliamentary questions are submitted in writing, in the last legislative period there were more than 8,000.

For the members of parliament it is probably one of the most important instruments, for members of the government probably often a source of annoyance and for journalists often a found food to get information. The parliamentary question certainly plays an important role in Luxembourg's political life. Especially for opposition politicians, it is a way to get media attention with comparatively little effort. This is also reflected in the way in which many parties advertise the parliamentary questions of their MPs: prominently on their websites, social media channels and also, depending on the topic, by press release.

On 10 April, parliament published a document on the government's Open Data Portal (data.public.lu) with all parliamentary questions from the last legislative period, which ran from 2018 to 2023. This enabled woxx to carry out an analysis of the requests, which would otherwise have been difficult or impossible to do.

The document contains 8,024 parliamentary questions and answers to them. The Chamber's website contains statistical reports on the work of the parliamentary sessions, which, like the school year, begin in September and end in July of the following year. It also notes how many parliamentary questions have been asked and how many have been

answered. If you add up those of the five sessions of the last legislative period, you get 8,385 parliamentary questions. The difference is probably explained by questions that were asked towards the end of the legislative period and were no longer answered, and questions that were declared inadmissible and thus never answered. Either way, there has been a considerable increase in the number of parliamentary questions: between 2013 and October 2018, a total of 4,085 questions were asked. A doubling – but who is responsible for it?

The gut feeling would point to the Pirate Party, after all, its MPs Sven Clement and Marc Goergen were new to parliament after the 2018 elections. They have indeed proven to be very diligent questioners: the two have asked 1,506 parliamentary questions in their first five years on the opposition bench. This enormous number of questions was certainly also due to the fact that the Pirate Party gave the population the opportunity to submit ideas for parliamentary questions with the website fro.lu. However, according to the website, only 90 of the 1,506 questions came from the portal. According to woxx information, at least in the first few months after entering parliament, there was also a lot of pressure within the party to fabricate as many inquiries as possible.

Inquisitive CSV

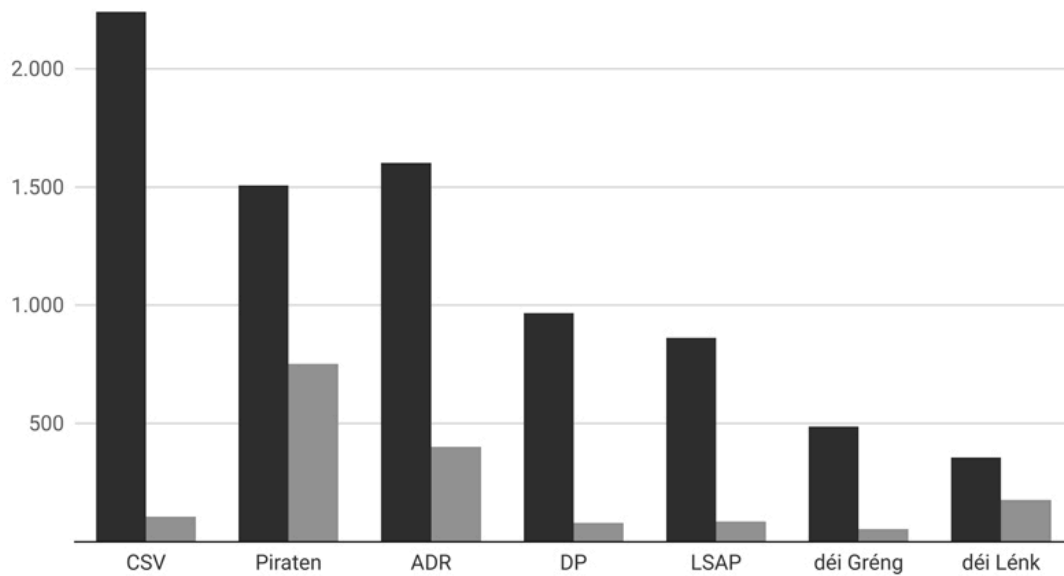
However, the Pirate Party is only in third place in terms of the number of questions. The ADR came in second place with 1,602 parliamentary questions. In the legislative period 2018 to 2023, the largest opposition party, the CSV, asked the most questions, namely 2,241. The MPs of the three governing parties at the time had fewer questions: the DP had 967, the LSAP MPs asked 863 questions and Déi Gréng had only 488. In the short time that Roy Reding was listed as a member of his newly founded

On average, a member of parliament asked 133.7 questions. However, this approach is a little unfair, as the President of Parliament does not ask parliamentary questions. If you don't count him, there are 136 questions that each member of parliament asked. However, this value is very theoretical, as some members of parliament were very diligent question writers, while others tended to hold back. The median value is 75 – half of the MPs asked more questions, half less. In addition, many questions are asked by several MEPs.

In total, these were 1,474 questions, which accounts for just over 18 percent, about a fifth of all questions asked. The frontrunners here were the deputies of Déi Lénk, who submitted just over 38 percent of their parliamentary questions in pairs. However, this approach is not necessarily due to political convictions, as the CSV, Déi Gréng and the DP also asked a little more than a quarter of their questions in pairs or more. Among the parties that wrote a particularly large number of questions, the glory is not so gladly shared: The deputies of the Pirate Party asked only 3.6 percent of their questions together, while the ADR asked almost 8 percent.

Who asked and who had to answer?

The ten most diligent questioners were Marc Goergen (807), Sven Clement (778), Martine Hansen (632), Fernand Kartheiser (595), Jeff Engelen (587), Mars Di Bartolomeo (445), André Bauler (421), Laurent Mosar (398), Gusty Graas (340) and Marc Spautz (287) – together they were (co-)responsible for almost 66 percent of parliamentary questions. Since not all members of parliament sat in parliament for the entire term of office, it is quite easy to explain why some of them asked very few questions. However, there are three that did not receive any parliamentary questions at all. Fernand Etgen (DP) had a good excuse as president of parliament, but his party colleagues Lydie Polfer and Simone Beissel do not seem to be fans of the meritocracy principle otherwise so attached to liberal parties when it comes to parliamentary work. Or they simply already know everything and therefore have no questions.



Erstellt mit Datawrapper

(Graphic: wxxx)

Parliamentary questions are always addressed to one or more ministers, who are known to often have several portfolios. François Bausch received the most mail, answering 1,494 questions, a full 18.6 percent of all questions. Unsurprisingly for the Corona legislative period, Paulette Lenert was confronted with a similar number of questions, namely 1,291, which corresponds to 16 percent. Again, those who have not been a minister for a long time could not answer so many questions, which is why Max Hahn brought up the rear with only 14. Despite an entire term in office, the two DP ministers Lex Delles (197) and Marc Hansen (197) were spared many questions. Again, many questions were answered by more than one minister.

It is noteworthy that the ministers of LSAP and Déi Gréng answered about the same number of questions: 4,563 compared to 4,175, i.e. just over half of all questions each. However, the DP ministers concerned only 2,923 of the parliamentary questions, which corresponds to about a third. However, this was probably due to the departments, some of which caused significantly more questions than others. The Ministry of Health had to answer most of the questions, with 1,416 slightly more than the Ministry of Mobility, which had to write down an answer to the members of parliament 1,228 times. The Ministry of the Environment, the Ministry of Education and the Ministry of Finance were also in great demand. These five ministries were involved in 61 percent of the responses.

The Ministry of Tourism (50 answers), the Ministry of Digitalisation (60 answers) and the Ministry of Economic Affairs (62 answers) were the least popular. A question was put to all members of the government. It came from the then CSV deputies Gilles Roth and Laurent Mosar and dealt with the influence of consulting companies on governments. The answer is rather boring: Roth and Mosar were referred to a parliamentary question by Sven Clement that had already been answered. By the way, according to the internal regulations of the Chamber, there is a ban on asking the same question twice within a year, unless the legislative period is changing.

Between 0 and 169 days

Ministers have one month to respond. For urgent requests, a deadline of one week applies. Only the

to Xavier Bettel, Taina Bofferding (LSAP) and Sam Tanson (Déi Gréng), changed recipients several times and was finally answered by Tanson together with François Bausch. Sometimes it happens very quickly: Some questions were answered on the same day. However, it should be noted that the data on the question and answer date was entered manually, which inevitably resulted in some typos – woxx was able to correct the obvious ones, but could not check over 8,000 entries.

It is also interesting to take a look at the languages used. These were not recorded by the Chamber manually, but automatically, as an employee of the parliament explained to woxx. As a result, the language was not always recognized correctly or two languages were recognized even though only one was used. As far as it was comprehensible to woxx, this happened especially with questions in Luxembourgish, where German was also recognized as the language. The most widely used language was Luxembourgish, which was used in about 56 percent of all parliamentary questions. French came in second place with just under 40 percent. German played only a very subordinate role with about 1.23 percent. There were even more questions that mixed Luxembourgish and French (2.79 percent), for example, when longer passages from legal texts were quoted.

The data that the Parliament has put online is not perfect, but it can serve journalists and the interested public to refute "gut feelings" and carry out more in-depth analyses. For example, one could find out which media are quoted particularly often and gladly by members of parliament when they ask their questions; woxx has been awarded this "honour" eleven times.

On May 1, the Chamber – inspired by inquiries from woxx – uploaded a new version of the document with all parliamentary questions to data.public.lu. All information in this article refers to the first version.



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: Une vague de cyclistes intergénérationnelle

YOLÈNE LE BRAS
30.07.2026

Chaque été, l'itinéraire de Dynamobile est différent. Cette année, l'expédition à vélo partant de Belgique traverse le Luxembourg.

Future: Putin, the Disintegration Administrator

THORSTEN FUCHSHUBER
30.07.2026

Acute fuel shortages, rising dissatisfaction: There are currently increasing reports that Vladimir Putin's rule has become fragile. But the system he created has been based on the exploitation of decline from the very beginning.

la Direction de l'immigration : Mémoire sélective

FABIEN GRASSER
23.07.2026

Les affaires de corruption présumée à la Direction de l'immigration ont débuté quand Jean Asselborn en était le ministre de tutelle. Elles se sont poursuivies sous le mandat de Léon Gloden. Tous deux affirment n'avoir eu qu'une connaissance limitée des faits, qui sont pourtant d'une exceptionnelle gravité.

Transports publics : Le TICE sur une route sinueuse

LÉO-PAUL HOFFMANN
16.07.2026

Les problèmes de personnel au TICE sont un serpent de mer. Un piquet de protestation organisé en septembre 2025 devait ouvrir un débat sur les conditions de travail au sein du réseau de bus du sud du pays. Mais la direction joue la montre, alors que le TICE changera de statute en 2027. L'État fera alors son entrée dans la structure, mais pour l'instant il ne dévoile rien de ses intentions, ajoutant au flou ambiant.

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